

Ambassador Program Orientation

Awareness. Advocacy. Adventure.



Summit
BECHTEL RESERVE™



Welcome!

Thank you for volunteering to be a Summit
Ambassador!

Agenda

- Foundations: Vision setting, mission centering, and the Core Values of the Summit Bechtel Reserve
- The Ambassador and the Awareness, Advocacy, Adventure model
- The Scouting programs of the Summit
- Choosing an event
- Resources and results

Foundations

What values drive us?



The Vision

To inspire and empower Scouts and Scouters across the country by connecting every unit to the formative and transformative outdoor experiences of the Summit Bechtel Reserve.

The Mission

The Summit Bechtel Reserve Ambassadors serve as a critical link to units, districts, councils, and other Scouting bodies to drive awareness and inspire participation in the formative and transformative Scouting experiences offered at the Summit.

The Summit Core Values

- Every Scouting program at the program is centered around the Core Values of the Summit
 - **Adventure**: Trying new things and reaching new heights, at any and every ability level
 - **Service**: Providing cheerful service to the Summit, the community, and Scouting
 - **Sustainability**: Ensuring that what is here today will be here tomorrow
 - **Leadership**: Fostering confidence and competence to create individuals who make ethical and moral choices over their lifetimes

The Ambassador



Who is a Summit Ambassador? What are their roles and responsibilities?

The Model: Awareness. Advocacy. Adventure.

- The tagline of the Summit Ambassador Program summarizes the basic responsibilities of the Summit Ambassador
 - **Awareness**: Works to ensure all stakeholders, including Scouts, Scouters, and parents at the unit, district, and council levels, know what is possible at the Summit
 - **Advocacy**: Speak from experience, and encourage Scouts, Scouters, and parents to say “yes” to the Summit
 - **Adventure**: Scouting promises adventure for Scouts and Scouters; share your memories and return to the Summit to make new ones!

The Ambassador

- The Summit Ambassador is a Scouter who can inspire interest and participation in the Summit by promoting the tremendous programs offered
 - Current or former seasonal staff members
 - Jamboree volunteer staff members
 - Unit leaders or Scouts-turned-Scouters who have participated in a Summit summer or training program or in a jamboree at the Summit
 - Any individual who has a passion for Scouting and the Summit!
- Past staff members and guests and influential Scouters have stories to tell and ideas to share that can encourage others to action

Your Role and Responsibilities

- As a Summit Ambassador, you are a go-to expert for all things Summit!
 - **Build awareness:** Share information and stories about Summit programs through presentations, table displays, and individual conversations
 - **Drive participation:** Encourage Scouts, Scouters, and parents to visit for a high-adventure program, Scout camp, or a leadership training program
 - **Support units and individuals:** Help units and Scouters who are considering or planning a visit by answering questions or pointing them to the right resources
 - **Be a connector:** You are a critical link between the units and districts in your council and the national network of Summit Ambassadors
 - **Represent the values:** Model the ideals of Adventure, Service, Sustainability, and Leadership in how you show up

Summit Scouting Programs



What does the Summit have to offer? What are we promoting?

High-Adventure Experiences

- The Summit Bechtel Reserve offers **five** incredible high-adventure experiences
 - Summit Experience
 - New River Experience
 - A.T.V. Experience
 - Marksman Experience
 - Pack 'n' Paddle Experience
 - Order of the Arrow Summit Experience

Summit Experience

- The Summit Experience is the signature on-site high-adventure program, and it includes a little bit of everything!
 - **Aerial sports**, including climbing, rappelling, and Leap of Faith at the Rocks; a zip down Alexander's Eagle Flight (the Big Zip); canopy zip tour; and challenge course
 - **Mountain biking** on some of the many miles of purpose-built trails
 - **Range and target fun**, like static, long-distance, target, and action archery; shotgun and rifle shooting (.22, .223, and .308)
 - **Skateboarding and BMX** at some of the best facilities in the world for these sports
 - **Whitewater rafting** on the New River
 - **Hunter education and LaserShot** in the Crafton Skills Center
- A great first (minimum age of thirteen) or capstone high-adventure experience!



New River Experience

- Fifty-mile paddle trek on the New River
- Navigate the upper portion of the river in inflatable kayaks called “duckies”
 - This portion of the river includes Class I to III rapids
- The final whitewater day in the Lower Canyon is a group rafting experience
 - Includes Class III to IV+ rapids
- Crews camp along the river through the New River Gorge
- A gear boat (raft) accompanies the group to transport gear and food
- Includes a ride on Alexander’s Eagle Flight (the Big Zip)
- A true trek experience, open to Scouts fourteen and older



A.T.V. Experience

- Forty-mile (plus) onsite A.T.V. trek
- Includes A.S.I. Rider Course training and extensive safety and handling instruction
- Ride on single-track, double-track, and gravel trails, while gaining confidence and competence under the guidance of A.S.I.-trained staff
- Gain skills in maintenance and repair through training from our mechanic staff
- Crews have the option to go on whitewater rafting trip on the final day
- Includes a ride on Alexander's Eagle Flight (Big Zip)
- A trek experience for Scouts fourteen and older

Marksman Experience

- The Marksman Experience offers range and target fun (and advanced firearms training) like no other Scouting program can!
 - Five-stand shotgun
 - Sporting clays
 - .22 pistol, 9mm pistol
 - .22, .223, .308 rifle shooting
 - .224 Valkyrie on thousand-yard range
 - Archery, including crossbows
- A half-day of whitewater rafting on the New River is included, along with a zip on Alexander's Eagle Flight (the Big Zip)
- This program is open to Scouts fourteen and older

Pack 'n' Paddle Experience

- The Pack 'n' Paddle Experience will allow Scouts and Scouters to explore the Summit, its history, and its ecology by hitting the trails!
 - Forty-plus miles of hiking through the beautiful Summit site
 - Opportunities for development and experience
 - Teambuilding experiences
 - Leave No Trace training and application
- A day of whitewater rafting on the New River is included
- A zip down Alexander's Eagle Flight (Big Zip) is included, too!
- This program is open to Scouts thirteen and older (and is a great way to prepare for a longer backpacking experience)



Justice National Scout Camp

- The James C. Justice National Scout Camp at the Summit Bechtel Reserve offers a traditional Scout summer camp program on property
 - More than **eighty** merit badges instructed by individuals eighteen or older
 - High-adventure buy-up programs for more fun
 - Options include rafting, skateboarding, BMX, mountain biking, aerial sports activities, range and target programs, and more!
 - First-year camper program that allows new Scouts to make some program selections
 - Evening programs and activities, across a range of areas, each night
 - Program areas are close to the main camping area
 - Heated showers in all facilities, with three brand-new individual shower/restroom facilities

Order of the Arrow Summit Experience

- The Order of the Arrow Summit Experience combines service and adventure for Arrowmen between the ages of fourteen and seventeen
- Under the supervision of adult Arrowmen, Scouts complete service to the Summit or to the New River Gorge National Park for three days
- The final two days include special adventure program experiences
- This program emphasizes challenge, teamwork, and reflection
- This is the earliest Order of the Arrow High Adventure experience an Arrowman can have (eligibility for programs at other bases starts at sixteen)

Training and Leadership Center

- The Summit Bechtel Reserve offers top-tier training for Scouts and Scouters
 - National Advanced Youth Leadership Experience (N.A.Y.L.E.) for Scouts
 - National Wood Badge training for Scouters
 - Seabadge training for Scouters
 - Certified Angler Instructor training for Scouts and Scouters
 - Leave No Trace Level II Educator training for Scouts and Scouters

Home of the National Scout Jamboree

- The Summit is the permanent home of the national Scout jamboree, held around every four years
- This event brings together thousands of Scouts and Scouters from across the country (and from all over the world)
- With hundreds of programs, arena shows, special guests, and lots of new friends to meet, the jamboree experience is one-of-a-kind
- Many Scouts and Scouters will know the Summit primarily because of or only because of the jamboree!

Other Reasons to Visit the Summit

- The Summit offers many reasons to visit!
 - Winter weekends (stay at the Summit while your troop goes skiing)
 - A.T.V. weekends for Scout units
 - Dormitory and camping space available throughout the year
 - Program possibilities for off-season camping between March-May and August-October
 - Host a wedding, conference, meeting, or other event

Events and Venues



Where do we want to have a presence?

Choosing an Event

- There are many Scouting events where the Summit could be represented!
- Council events
 - Universities of Scouting (which often have midways)
 - Merit badge colleges
 - Special events (large gatherings with vendors, e.g.)
- District events
 - Roundtables
 - Camporees
- Unit (troop/crew/post) meetings

Other Events to Consider

- Order of the Arrow conclaves
- Territory program conferences
- Wood Badge or camp reunions
- Alumni gatherings
- Council recognition dinners and Friends of Scouting events
- There are many in-person and virtual venues where it makes sense for us to be!

Representing the Summit



How do we represent the Summit at the events we attend? What resources are available to us?

What Do I Need?

- There are some basic things you should plan to have when you represent the Summit:
 - Current information about Summit Scouting programs
 - Contact information for general and specific requests
 - Giveaways (optional)
 - Displays (optional)
- Digital resources are available at www.summitbsa.org/ambassadors
 - Presentation(s) you can download and modify
 - Printable resources
 - Requests for displays and/or giveaways to be mailed to you

What Should I Wear?

- We want to present a clean and professional look; here are some suggestions for what to wear:
 - Any Summit shirt or sweatshirt/hoodie/jacket
 - A Scouting field uniform (preferably with a Summit patch!)
 - A Summit Ambassador polo!

Tracking and Recognition



How do we note events we want to attend? How do we track our results? What are the expectations?

Selecting Events

- When you select an event, we ask that you let us know by submitting an *Event Attendance Report/Request*, which can be completed online
- In this report/request form, we will collect the following information:
 - What is the event?
 - Where is the event? Is it in person or virtual?
 - What is the audience?
 - What resources do you need/would you like to have to be prepared?
 - Do you have any questions or needs with which the Summit can assist prior to your attendance?
- Ambassadors are asked to participate in **at least three events per year**



Tracking Results

- After you represent the Summit at an event, we ask that you complete a brief after-action report (online form) to let us know:
 - How many people attended the event
 - With how many people you spoke
 - Any notes for needed follow-ups with anyone to whom you spoke
 - Notes for what worked well for you
 - Suggestions for ways we can improve

Recognizing You!

- We are extremely grateful for the time and energy you are committing to this effort!
- We have established three levels to recognize these efforts:
 - **Summit Ambassador**: Completes the orientation and signs the ambassador agreement; receives ambassador nametag and button
 - **Senior Ambassador**: Serves as an ambassador for two years and represents the Summit at six or more events over this time; receives the Summit Ambassador patch and newsletter recognition
 - **Master Ambassador**: Serves as an ambassador for two or more years or serves as a regional coordinator for one year and mentors at least one new ambassador; receives a Summit Ambassador patch and polo, newsletter recognition, and free two-night stay in Family Adventure Camp each year



Looking Toward the Future



Where does the Summit Ambassador Program go from here?

The Future of this Program

- The Summit Ambassador Program is beginning formally at the end of 2026
- To begin, ambassadors will report to and receive support from a full-time member of the Summit program staff
- Eventually, the program will transition to using regional/area coordinators, through which most ambassadors will request/receive support
- Because this program is in its pilot stage, there may be changes and adjustments that occur (based on observations and your feedback)
 - Thank you in advance for your flexibility!

Thank You, Again!

- Please let us know any questions that you have now.
- Thank you for your time and dedication to the Summit and Scouting!